

What Does It Takes To Quit Shopping?

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General Comprehension

The article explores how many Americans are pushing back against aggressive social media marketing and consumerist culture by adopting “No Buy” or “Low Buy” pledges to curb compulsive shopping habits driven by targeted ads and addictive online retail platforms.

True or False

1. Ads are seamlessly integrated into social media news feeds. **TRUE**

“On TikTok, ads for phone stands, wigs and kitchen sink strainers are nearly indistinguishable from content creators opining about reality-TV shows and politics.”

2. To fight against the consumerist culture, some people decided to boycott Black Friday. **FALSE**

The text mentions a boycott, but it targets large corporations for 24 hours on a Friday, not specifically Black Friday: “The group is asking people not to buy from large corporations — in person or online — for 24 hours.”

3. Devon Rule’s app enables people to swap items they have in their closets rather than buy new ones. **FALSE**

The text never mentions an app or swapping items. It only states that her business model is about “helping you use what you have” and that she is “competing with shopping.”

4. The new “low buy” trend is mainly the result of the US crisis: more people want to save money. **FALSE**

“The zeal that is driving this trend is as much a pushback against the forces of a consumerist culture as it is about saving money, with scorn for corporate manipulation mixed in with tips for changing personal habits.”

Vocabulary: what words or expressions in **BOLD** correspond to the following definitions?

To control or limit something = to curb (VB)

To sell goods informally in public places = to hawk (VB)

When not working or with low activity = downtime (NOUN)

To unsubscribe = to opt out (VB)

A great number of = barrage (NOUN)

To come together in large numbers = to flock (VB)

To persuade, to tempt = to entice (VB)

Ways of persuading someone = wiles (NOUN)

Freedom within limits = leeway (NOUN)

Overloaded, packed = bulging (ADJ)

Can you **REPHRASE** and **EXPLAIN** what is **IMPLIED** in the following sentences?

- “Their containers of blush hit pan.”

“Hit pan” means that the product is almost empty, implying that the person has used it a lot and is very satisfied with it.

- “Having influencers hawk products and promote hauls.”

Refers to the strategy used by influencers to sell products by showcasing them in their content.

- “Spending bans are great,...”

The sentence implies that spending bans can be effective in helping people control their shopping habits, but the use of “great” and the ellipsis suggests that there may be some limitations or challenges associated with them.

- “I think it just comes down to me being in the practice of scrolling past.”

Ms Orakpo says that she has developed a habit of ignoring ads while scrolling through social media, which helps her avoid being tempted to shop.

Mr Jhavar’s idea

- Say what Mr Jhavar’s idea is in one sentence.

Mr Jhavar’s idea is to send customers a more personalized marketing to customers using artificial intelligence and texts to your phone.

- What advantages does he list to promote this new idea? Give 4.

1. People open text messages more than emails
2. Texts feel more personal to customers
3. It’s easier to opt out of text messages than emails
4. Messages are easier to get personalized with AI

- Line 47 “Some people might consider Mr Jhavar part of the problem.” Can you explain what is implied using arguments from the text? (in your own words)

Throughout the text, social media marketing is described as predatory and manipulative. Since Mr Jhavar uses AI to send targeted messages and lure shoppers back to websites they have already left, he is contributing to the very “ecosystem” that compulsive buyers are desperately trying to escape.